

10/14 WEDNESDAY — STORY OUTLINE

Airdate: Wednesday, October 14, 2026 · **Stories:** A + B + C, confirmed by the producer 10/6 (jeff_approval.md) · **Guest:** not booked (Amy Nofziger, AARP, suggested) · **Sponsor:** OmniWatch (2 breaks) · **Stage:** beats

RUNNING ORDER

Slot	What	Weight	Clips
Tease	The \$26,000 free sample, the caregiver who took the house for \$5, the fake property-tax video	—	—
A	This free sample cost her \$26,000	~50% of show	6
Break	OmniWatch — after A beat 8 (the fix)	—	—
B	Don't sign this for anyone: his caregiver took his house for \$5	~35%	3
Break	OmniWatch — after B beat 4 (the fix)	—	—
C	If you see this video about your property taxes, it's fake	~15%	2
End	End of show	—	—

The show in three sentences

A free sample at the mall turns into a chair, a pitch and a bill in the tens of thousands, and the same playbook is hitting older shoppers from Florida to Washington. A caregiver became a 75-year-old man's power of attorney and signed his house over to herself for \$5, and his daughter found out through the doorbell. A fake AI "government" video wants your Social Security number for a tax freeze that doesn't exist, and every one of these has a one-line fix.

The ride

A builds through four victims to a store going dark and exhales on the fix. B is the darkest stretch (a death, a daughter treated as a trespasser) and lands on the arrest. C is quick and practical. The show exhales on C, not on a good-news closer.

Decisions before we write

- Which story leads: the outline follows the producer's note (skincare A, caregiver B). Kyle and David's note had the caregiver story as the lead.
- A beat 2: the \$26,000 widow is a June 2025 case. Open on her as "last year," or open on a 2026 CBS LA victim and use her as the dollar figure?
- A runs 6 clip beats against Matt's guide of about two per segment. Beats 5 and 6 are the same outlet (CBS LA) and the softest cut.
- B beat 2: the tease line "Your dad died" is a paraphrase. Use the clip's actual words.
- C: the "file by Oct 15" deadline is unsourced. Drop it unless someone finds it in the video.
- C has no victim: beat 1 is the fake video itself. Run it as a quick warning, or ask the help line for a caller who saw it.
- Expert not booked. Without one, A beat 8 and B beat 4 stay with Jeff.

A. THIS FREE SAMPLE COST HER \$26,000

In one sentence: Mall skincare stores hand older shoppers a free sample, sit them down, and run up bills in the tens of thousands, and one store just closed after CBS LA's reports.

Peg: The Bee & Co. store at Westfield Topanga closed Sept 24 after months of CBS California Investigates reports (latest Oct 1).

Weight: ~50% of show · 6 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The hook	You (the viewer)	A worker at the mall hands you a free sample and asks you to sit down for a quick demo.	JEFF
2	The \$25 facial	Kathryn Taylor, 84, Florida widow on Social Security	She goes in for a \$25 facial and is charged about \$26,000; the store refunds about \$4,500 and nothing more.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — First Coast News
3	No, fifty times	Lettie, 79, Arizona, lives on Social Security	She says she said no 50 to 60 times and still spent about \$25,000 over a month.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — ABC15 Let Joe Know
4	It's not one store	Victor Chisholm, man with an intellectual disability	He spends more than \$50,000 at Bee & Co., and his friend Gabe Cota spends thousands more.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — CBS LA
5	It gets worse	Older and disabled Bee & Co. customers, including an 80-year-old woman	New complaints pile up across Southern California malls, and a congressman takes it to the attorney general.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — CBS LA
6	The store goes dark	Rep. Brad Sherman; Bee & Co. attorney Neville Johnson	The Topanga store closes Sept 24; the company calls the coverage one-sided and misleading.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — CBS LA
7	Coast to coast	Vancouver Mall shopper, 75, Washington	A kiosk owner is arrested after allegedly pushing her to withdraw \$50,000, and nearby kiosks close.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — KOIN 6
8	The fix	You (the viewer)	Take the sample and keep walking, get the total in writing, and dispute charges the same day.	JEFF

The fix

- Never sit down for a "free" demo. Take the sample and keep walking.
- Ask for the total in writing before you hand over a card. Never sign a "final sale" form you can't read.
- Already charged? Call your card company the same day and dispute it; report it at [ReportFraud.ftc.gov](https://www.ftc.gov/report-fraud).

Gaps

- ⚠ Beat 2 is from June 2025, and Taylor's "Bee and Co" isn't tied to Mazal's Bee & Co. by any source.
- ⚠ Beats 4-7: accused of high-pressure sales, not charged with fraud (the Vancouver arrest is a separate case). Every line gets attribution and the company's response.
- ⚠ Georgia, from the original pitch: no case found. Don't say it.

B. DON'T SIGN THIS FOR ANYONE: HIS CAREGIVER TOOK HIS HOUSE FOR \$5

In one sentence: A caregiver became a 75-year-old's power of attorney, deeded his house to herself for \$5, told his daughter through the doorbell that he had died, and was arrested Sept 28.

Peg: Sarah Smalls was arrested Sept 28; WMBF's follow-up ran Sept 29–30. Next court date Dec 11.

Weight: ~35% of show · 3 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The \$5 deed	Robert Rowland, 75, Conway, South Carolina	His caregiver becomes his power of attorney, then a quitclaim deed moves his house to her for \$5.	HAVE · VERTICAL — WSMV Short
2	The doorbell	Nora Rowland, his daughter	She rings the Ring doorbell; the caregiver says he died three days earlier, and police treat Nora as the trespasser.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — Inside Edition
3	The arrest	Sarah Smalls, 58, the caregiver (accused)	She is arrested Sept 28 on charges including exploitation of a vulnerable adult; she has not been convicted.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — WMBF follow-up
4	The fix	You (the viewer)	Never make a paid caregiver your power of attorney, and sign up for your county's deed alert.	JEFF

The fix

- Never make a paid caregiver your power of attorney. Name a family member or a lawyer.
- Sign up for your county's free property-fraud alert.
- Suspect it? Call Adult Protective Services through the Eldercare Locator, 1-800-677-1116.

Gaps

- △ Beat 1: the 5.7M Short is WSMV's repost of WMBF's story. Clear it through Gray.
- △ Beat 2: "Your dad died" is a paraphrase; sources say "had died three days earlier."
- △ Beat 3: accused, not convicted. Don't name the home-care agency; sources disagree on its name.

C. IF YOU SEE THIS VIDEO ABOUT YOUR PROPERTY TAXES, IT'S FAKE

In one sentence: A fake AI video tells seniors Congress froze their property taxes and pushes a form that doesn't exist, and the phone number reaches scammers who want your Social Security number.

Peg: Official warnings from Wisconsin (Sept 3–11), Ohio, California and Colorado, still circulating into October.

Weight: ~15% of show · 2 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The fake video	Unnamed — scammers behind an AI video, no victim found	The video claims a new federal senior tax freeze and a "Senior Homeowner Tax Review Request" form.	FIND · HORIZONTAL BROLL — the scam video or a news grab of it
2	The warning	David Casey, Wisconsin revenue secretary, and county auditors	Officials say no such law or form exists, and the number in the video goes to scammers.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — local news warning
3	The fix	You (the viewer)	Property taxes are local; call the number on your tax bill and never give your SSN to "file."	JEFF

The fix

- Property taxes are set by your county and state, never by Congress. There is no federal form.
- Call your assessor at the number on your tax bill, not one from a video.
- Never give your Social Security number to "file" for a freeze.

Gaps

- △ No victim found. The story is the warning, not a person.
- △ The "file by Oct 15" deadline is unsourced.
- △ Local warning clips are all under 1,000 views. The scam video itself may be down.